

Samanvay — Team Onboarding & Product Understanding Document

Version: 1.0 Status: Product Definition Frozen Audience: Developers, Designers, Product Team, Contributors

1. Why Samanvay Exists

Today most NGOs operate independently.

Even when organizations work in the same city, same district, or even on the same social issue, coordination is often manual.

Organizations rely on:

- Phone calls
- WhatsApp groups
- Personal contacts
- Spreadsheets
- Informal networks

As a result:

- Resources remain unused while others face shortages
- Volunteers are underutilized
- Donors lack transparency
- Collaboration depends on personal relationships rather than systems

Samanvay exists to solve this problem.

2. What Samanvay Is

Samanvay is a coordination operating system for the social sector.

It allows NGOs, volunteers, donors, institutions, and partners to work together through a shared coordination infrastructure while maintaining ownership of their own resources.

The platform does not own NGO resources.

The platform owns the coordination layer.

This distinction is fundamental.

3. The Core Philosophy

Every organization remains independent.

No NGO loses ownership of:

- Resources
- Volunteers
- Funds
- Assets
- Operations

Samanvay only helps organizations discover opportunities to collaborate.

The platform coordinates.

It does not control.

4. The Society Analogy

The easiest way to understand Samanvay is through a housing society analogy.

Imagine:

NGO A owns a house. NGO B owns a house. NGO C owns a house.

Samanvay is the society.

The society provides:

- Roads
- Parks
- Security
- Shared facilities
- Community services

But the society does not own the houses.

Similarly:

NGOs own their resources.

Samanvay provides:

- Coordination
 - Matching
 - Transparency
 - Collaboration infrastructure
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5. Ownership Domains

Every major entity in the system belongs to one of three domains.

Private

Owned by an individual organization.

Examples:

- NGO inventory
- NGO treasury
- Internal volunteers

Only that organization can modify these assets.

Other organizations cannot directly access them.

Shared

Owned by Samanvay.

Examples:

- Community volunteer pool
- Community emergency fund
- Shared logistics network

Access is controlled by platform policies.

Collaborative

Temporary shared ownership.

Examples:

- Joint campaigns
- Cross-NGO volunteer assignments
- Resource transfers

Created only through explicit approval.

Destroyed when collaboration ends.

6. Who Uses Samanvay

NGOs

Can:

- Manage resources
 - Create events
 - Request help
 - Offer support
 - Coordinate with partners
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Volunteers

Can:

- Join organizations
 - Participate in events
 - Offer skills
 - Join shared volunteer pools
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Donors

Can:

- Contribute funds
 - View spending reports
 - Monitor transparency
 - Track impact
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Platform Administrators

Can:

- Verify organizations
 - Resolve disputes
 - Govern community resources
 - Manage trust systems
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7. The Four Core Assets

Everything in Samanvay revolves around four asset classes.

Resources

Examples:

- Food
 - Medicines
 - Equipment
 - Vehicles
 - Clothing
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Volunteers

Examples:

- Doctors
 - Teachers
 - Drivers
 - Coordinators
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Funds

Examples:

- NGO treasury
 - Event budgets
 - Community funds
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Capabilities

Examples:

- Medical response
- Legal aid
- Disaster management
- Counseling

Capabilities represent expertise rather than physical assets.

8. Events Are the Center of Operations

Almost every activity eventually becomes an event.

Examples:

- Medical Camp
- Food Distribution Drive
- Blood Donation Camp
- Awareness Program
- Emergency Relief Operation
- Fundraising Campaign

Events consume:

- Resources
- Volunteers
- Funds
- Capabilities

Events produce:

- Reports
 - Outcomes
 - Impact
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9. The Core Coordination Engines

These engines are the primary differentiators of Samanvay.

Without them, Samanvay becomes just another NGO management platform.

Engine 1 — Resource Coordination Engine

Purpose:

Coordinate physical resources between organizations.

Examples:

- Food
- Medicines
- Equipment
- Vehicles

Workflow:

Need → Discovery → Offer → Approval → Transfer

Example:

NGO B needs 100 food packets.

System discovers:

NGO A has surplus inventory.

NGO A sends an offer.

NGO B accepts.

Transfer happens.

Inventory updates.

Important:

No NGO can directly access another NGO's inventory.

All transfers require explicit approval.

Engine 2 — Volunteer Coordination Engine

Purpose:

Coordinate human resources.

Volunteer attributes:

- Skills
- Availability
- Location
- Certifications

Workflow:

Need → Matching → Invitation → Acceptance → Assignment

Example:

Medical camp needs 5 doctors.

System finds matching volunteers.

Volunteers accept invitations.

Assignments are created.

Attendance is recorded.

Important:

Volunteer consent is always required.

Engine 3 — Fund Allocation Engine

Purpose:

Manage money transparently.

Fund types:

- NGO Fund
- Campaign Fund
- Community Fund

Workflow:

Contribution → Fund → Budget Allocation → Expenditure → Reporting

Important:

Funds operate using an append-only ledger.

No transaction is ever deleted.

Balances are calculated from transaction history.

Engine 4 — Capability Coordination Engine

Purpose:

Coordinate expertise between organizations.

Example:

An NGO may not have medicines or volunteers available.

However, it may have:

- Disaster response expertise
- Legal support
- Medical teams

The capability engine allows organizations to request and provide expertise.

Workflow:

Capability Need → Discovery → Offer → Approval → Deployment

10. Donor Transparency

One of Samanvay's strongest features.

Donor money is pooled within the fund it is donated to.

Example:

Community Fund

Donor A: ₹500

Donor B: ₹1000

Donor C: ₹500

Fund Total: ₹2000

Spending:

₹1000 Food Distribution

₹500 Medicines

Remaining: ₹500

The platform tracks how the fund is used.

It does not attempt to trace individual currency notes.

This keeps accounting realistic while maintaining transparency.

11. Future Systems

These are intentionally deferred until enough data exists.

Trust System

Measures reliability.

Factors:

- Fulfillment rate
 - Attendance
 - Transparency
 - Response time
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Verification System

Confirms that actions actually occurred.

Methods:

- OTP

- Documents
 - Photos
 - Third-party verification
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Impact Engine

Creates immutable impact records.

Examples:

- Meals served
 - Beneficiaries reached
 - Volunteer hours contributed
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Analytics System

Provides insights into:

- Resource shortages
 - Volunteer demand
 - Regional trends
 - Funding utilization
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12. What Success Looks Like

Success is not:

"Thousands of NGOs using the software."

Success is:

"Independent organizations coordinating effectively through the platform."

A successful Samanvay ecosystem allows:

- Resources to reach where they are needed
- Volunteers to find meaningful opportunities
- Donors to trust the system
- Organizations to collaborate efficiently

without sacrificing ownership, autonomy, or transparency.

Final Product Principle

Whenever a feature is proposed, ask:

"Does this help autonomous organizations coordinate better without taking away their ownership?"

If the answer is yes, it belongs in Samanvay.

If the answer is no, it is likely outside the platform's core mission.